

Nikhil Rao

CONTACT

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EMPLOYMENT	Postdoctoral Fellow , National Bureau of Economic Research	2025–Present
EDUCATION	Ph.D., Economics , University of Michigan	2025
	M.A., Economics , University of Michigan	2021
	B.A., Economics & Mathematics , University of Massachusetts Amherst	2015
FIELDS	Labor Economics, Applied Econometrics	
WORKING PAPERS	“The Socioeconomic Consequences of Misdemeanor Conviction” , with James Reeves. “Measuring Discrimination using Natural Experiments” , with James Reeves. “Network Spillovers and the Social Returns to Crime-Reduction Interventions” , with Ashley Craig, Sara Heller, and Kenneth Hofmeister. “Parental Resources and College Major Choice” , with Zsigmond Pálvölgyi & Tyler Radler.	
IN PROGRESS	“Peer Socioeconomic Mismatch and Student Achievement” , with Micah Y. Baum. “Examining Interventions to Improve Outcomes of Justice-involved Individuals” , with James Reeves.	
PUBLICATIONS	“Inflation Expectations and Nonlinearities in the Phillips Curve” , with Alexander Doser, Ricardo Nunes and Viacheslav Sheremirov. <i>Journal of Applied Econometrics</i> 38:4 (2023), 453-471. “Sectoral inflation and the Phillips curve: What has changed since the Great Recession?” , with Maria Jose Luengo-Prado and Viacheslav Sheremirov. <i>Economics Letters</i> 172 (2018), 63–68.	
EXTERNAL PRESENTATIONS	2026 (including upcoming) George Washington University Washington, DC Linnaeus University Växjö, Sweden Transatlantic Workshop on the Economics of Crime Ithaca, NY Opportunity Insights Conference on Economic Mobility Cambridge, MA Georgetown University Washington, DC CJARS 10-Year Anniversary Conference Ann Arbor, MI NBER SI (Law & Economics, Crime) Cambridge, MA Policy Impacts Annual Conference Cambridge, MA Federal Reserve Bank of Boston Boston, MA 2025 Tufts University Brownbag Medford, MA Workshop on the Economics of Crime for Junior Scholars Philadelphia, PA University of Colorado Denver, CO 2024 Southern Economic Association Meeting Washington, DC Association for Public Policy Analysis & Management Fall Conference National Harbor, MD Transatlantic Workshop on the Economics of Crime Zurich, Switzerland	

Western Economic Association Conference
Texas Economics of Crime Workshop

Seattle, WA
Austin, TX

2019

Midwest Macroeconomics Meeting

Lansing, MI

AWARDS & FELLOWSHIPS

Policy Impacts Early Career Scholars Grant	2026
Department of Economics Fellowship	2025
Rackham One Term Dissertation Fellowship	2024
Rackham Conference Travel Grant	2024 (x2)
Department of Economics Conference Travel Grant	2019; 2024 (x2)
Poverty Solutions One Term Fellowship	2023
Department of Economics Research Grant	2022; 2023
Sasakawa Young Leaders Fellowship	2018–2019

TEACHING

University of Michigan

Economics of the Population (ECON 466)	Fall 2020
Introductory Macroeconomics (ECON 102)	Winter 2020
Introductory Microeconomics (ECON 101)	Fall 2019

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE & EMPLOYMENT

University of Michigan

Graduate Research Assistant to Ashley Craig & Sara Heller	2020–2024
Summer Research Assistant to Ana Reynoso	2020
Summer Research Assistant to Lauren Falcao Bergquist	2019

Federal Reserve Bank of Boston

Senior Research Assistant, Jenny Tang & Viacheslav Sheremirov	2015–2018
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SERVICE

Referee: <i>American Law and Economics Review</i> , <i>Journal of Human Resources</i> , <i>Journal of Policy Analysis and Management</i> , <i>Quarterly Journal of Economics</i>	
Graduate Program Committee, University of Michigan Graduate Economics Society	2021–2022
Admissions Committee, University of Michigan Graduate Economics Society	2020–2021
Social Chair, University of Michigan Graduate Economics Society	2019–2020

OTHER

Analytics and Programming: Stata, R, Matlab and L^AT_EX

Clearance: U.S. Census Bureau, Special Sworn Status

Citizenship: USA

REFERENCES

Sara Heller

Associate Professor
Department of Economics
University of Michigan
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Basit Zafar

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Ashley Craig

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